

iFlytek (002230.SZ): Upgraded AI model to launch in Oct; 2Q26 rev miss on muted AI devices growth; Neutral

iFlytek targets to release an enhanced AI model based on the local computing platform in Oct 2026, supporting its open platform growth, ToB AI enterprise projects, and rising adoption of ToC AI devices despite near-term pressures of rising memory cost. The company's 2Q26 revenues were up 2% YoY to Rmb6.3bn, while 16% below our estimates, and we attribute it to slower-than-expected growth of its learning tablet. By segment, the enterprise AI and internet services delivered strong growth at 34%/ 41% YoY, followed by smart automotive/ smart education revenues growth at 30%/ 24% YoY in 1H26. Due to continuous investment on AI platform, the Opex spending is higher than expected, resulting in OP loss of Rmb368m vs. our estimates of Rmb165m OP income. We expect to see sequential revenues growth in 2H26E, driven by gradual recovery in AI devices, expanding ecosystem and application scenarios of AI open platform, supported by upgraded AI model. Maintain Neutral.

Upgraded AI model to launch in Oct: iFlytek plans to release the new generation of its AI foundational model (iFlytek Spark) in Oct 2026, featuring the upgraded AI coding capability and higher price-to-performance ratio of the token. Management highlights the company's AI model is based on the local computing chipset, and iFlytek continues to work on optimization to improve the computing efficiency with better performance, targeting key scenarios across education (AI learning tablet), medical, automotive, banks, productivity (AI meeting translation) etc.

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Exhibit 1: iFlytek 2Q26 result snapshot

	2Q26	2Q GSe	vs GSe	YoY	QoQ	2Q25	1Q22	1Q26
Sales (Rmb mn)	6,349	7,551	-16%	2%	20%	6,253	3,506	5,274
GM (%)	40.4%	40.3%	0.1ppts	0.1ppts	1.4ppts	40%	41%	39%
Gross profit	2,565	3,042	-16%	2%	25%	2,518	1,421	2,055
Opex ratio	46%	38%	8.1ppts	4.8ppts	-3.5ppts	41%	45%	50%
Operating profit (Rmb mn)	(368)	165	na	423%	-35%	(70)	(162)	(567)
OPM (%)	-5.8%	2.2%	-8ppts	-4.7ppts	4.9ppts	-1.1%	-4.6%	-10.7%
Net income (Rmb mn)	(34)	259	-113%	-25%	-80%	(46)	111	(170)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revision: We factor in iFlytek 2Q26 results and revise down earnings by 14%/ 13%/ 7% mainly on lower revenues and higher Opex ratio. We revise down revenues mainly on weaker-than-expected AI devices while remain positive on the long-term adoption ahead, and revise up Opex ratio to reflect higher R&D expenses.

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Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)	Old	New	Diff (%)
Revenue	32,572	30,984	-5%	38,727	36,420	-6%	43,442	41,672	-4%
Gross profit	13,200	12,463	-6%	16,286	15,163	-7%	18,156	17,294	-5%
Op. income	884	694	-21%	2,575	2,197	-15%	4,232	3,874	-8%
Net income	1,480	1,266	-14%	2,751	2,396	-13%	4,658	4,342	-7%
GM	40.5%	40.2%	-0.3ppts	42.1%	41.6%	-0.4ppts	41.8%	41.5%	-0.3ppts
OPM	2.7%	2.2%	-0.5ppts	6.6%	6.0%	-0.6ppts	9.7%	9.3%	-0.4ppts
NM	4.5%	4.1%	-0.5ppts	7.1%	6.6%	-0.5ppts	10.7%	10.4%	-0.3ppts

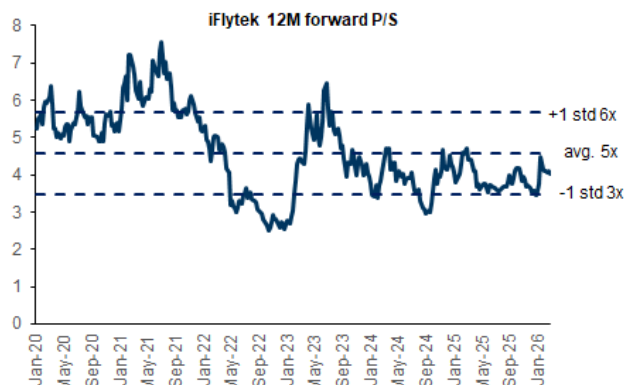
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: Our target price is derived from a DCF-based methodology (unchanged) to capture long-term cash flow generation. We model stage 2 FCF growth in 2032E-2036E at 12% YoY (rolled over the base year from 2026E to 2027E), and terminal growth at 2%, which is consistent with our China Tech coverage. We discount the value at a WACC of 11.5%, with a COE of 11.5% (beta at 1.3, risk free rate at 3.0%, market risk premium at 6.5%). Reflecting our earnings revisions, our DCF-based target price is at Rmb53.1 (vs. previously at Rmb61.5). Our TP-implied 2027E P/S is at 3.5x, between the company's avg. -1std P/S at 3x and avg. P/S at 5x.

Exhibit 3: iFlytek DCF valuation

	Stage 1											Stage 2				
Rmb mn	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E	2033E	2034E	2035E	2036E
P&L																
Revenue	18,314	18,820	19,650	23,343	27,105	30,984	36,420	41,672	46,780	52,522	58,825					
YoY	41%	3%	4%	19%	16%	14%	18%	14%	12%	12%	12%					
Opex ratio	36.8%	40.5%	42.2%	41.0%	38.9%	38.0%	35.6%	32.2%	30.9%	29.1%	26.0%					
OP income	788	69	89	378	936	694	2,197	3,874	4,835	6,305	9,412					
YoY		-91%	28%	324%	148%	-26%	217%	76%	25%	30%	49%					
Pretax income	1,497	248	420	229	593	1,134	2,647	4,717	5,798	7,451	10,558					
Net income	1,556	561	657	560	839	1,266	2,396	4,342	5,358	6,912	10,019					
YoY		-64%	17%	-15%	50%	51%	89%	81%	23%	29%	45%					
GPM	41.1%	40.8%	42.7%	42.6%	42.4%	40.2%	41.6%	41.5%	41.2%	41.1%	41.1%					
OPM	4.3%	0.4%	0.5%	1.6%	3.5%	2.2%	6.0%	9.3%	10.3%	12.0%	15.1%					
NPM	8.5%	3.0%	3.3%	2.4%	3.1%	4.1%	6.6%	10.4%	11.5%	13.2%	17.0%					
R&D spending (Rmb m)	2,830	3,111	3,214	3,892	4,788	5,585	6,000	6,668	7,157	7,353	8,236					
R&D%	15.5%	16.5%	16.4%	16.7%	17.7%	18.0%	16.5%	16.0%	15.3%	14.0%	14.0%					
AI learning tablet shipment (k units)	870	472	450	566	859	886	930	977	1,026	1,077	1,131					
AI learning tablet ASP (Rmb)	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200	3,200					
Spark AI empowered devices shipment (k units)			47	64	82	180	217	299	407	501	551					
Spark AI empowered devices ASP (Rmb)			8,958	12,087	9,476	8,802	8,284	7,903	7,834	7,745	7,745					
Cash flow																
CCC	21	35	48	60	49	50	33	21	4	(12)	(13)					
Capex	(1,249)	(2,082)	(2,268)	(4,082)	(3,220)	(2,500)	(2,800)	(2,600)	(2,700)	(2,702)	(2,700)					
Capex to revenues	7%	11%	12%	17%	12%	8%	8%	6%	6%	5%	5%					
Free cash flow	(1,189)	(1,637)	(3,732)	(725)	708	853	1,780	4,575	6,856	7,744	9,603	10,707	11,938	13,311	14,842	16,549
YoY						21%	109%	157%	50%	13%	24%	12%	12%	12%	12%	12%
Terminal growth																2.0%
Terminal value							1.00	0.90	0.80	0.72	0.65	0.58	0.52	0.47	0.42	178,625
Discount factor																0.38
Present value of FCF							1,780	4,103	5,515	5,587	6,213	6,213	6,213	6,213	6,213	6,213
Enterprise value 2027E (Rmb m)						121,323										
Cash and equivalents (net)						6,320										
Equity value in 2027E (Rmb m)						127,643										
Value per share (Rmb)						53.1										
WACC assumption (2027E)																
Risk free rate	3.0%															
Beta	1.30															
Market risk premium	6.5%															
Cost of equity	11.5%															
Cost of debt	6.0%															
Tax rate	15%															
WACC	11.5%															

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: iFlytek 12M forward P/S

Source: Eikon Datastream

Price Target Risks and Methodology - iFlytek

Valuation: We derive our 12m TP of Rmb53.1 from a two-stage DCF, where we incorporate a WACC of 11.5% and a terminal growth at 2% YoY. We are Neutral rated on iFlytek.

Risks (+/-) include: 1) Education contracts are stronger/worse than we expect, leading to higher/lower revenue growth; 2) competition is more/less intense than we expect; and 3) better-/worse-than-expected expense control.

002230.SZ	12m Price Target: Rmb53.10	Price: Rmb38.48	Upside: 38.0%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
Market cap: Rmb89.4bn / \$13.4bn Enterprise value: Rmb92.0bn / \$13.7bn 3m ADTV: Rmb1.6bn / \$236.3mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
		27,105.4	30,984.5	36,419.8	41,672.3
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	27,105.4	32,571.6	38,727.2	43,441.8
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	3,103.8	2,878.2	4,491.4	6,252.3
	EPS (Rmb) New	0.36	0.53	1.00	1.81
	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.36	0.64	1.19	2.02
	P/E (X)	136.4	72.3	38.6	21.3
	P/B (X)	6.1	4.6	4.2	3.6
	Dividend yield (%)	0.1	0.2	0.4	0.7
	CROCI (%)	12.2	11.5	14.6	17.9
	EPS (Rmb)	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		(0.01)	0.12	0.49	–

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 18 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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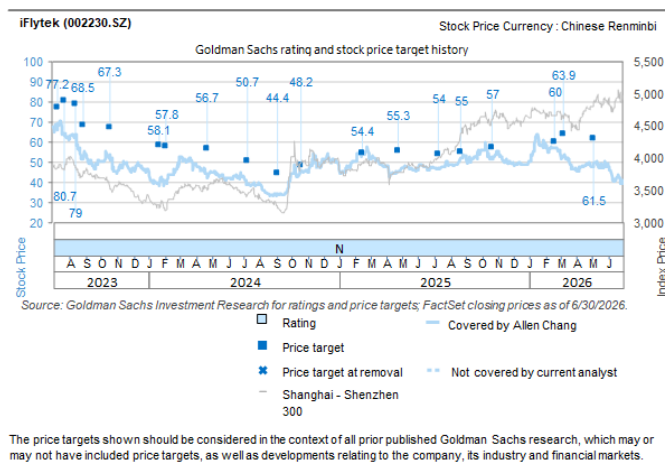
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

iFlytek (002230.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
06-May-26	61.50	49.48
09-Mar-26	63.90	53.50
20-Feb-26	60.00	57.12
22-Oct-25	57.00	51.75
23-Aug-25	55.00	52.22
11-Jul-25	54.00	46.98
24-Apr-25	55.30	45.19
17-Feb-25	54.40	55.05
20-Oct-24	48.20	45.83
04-Sep-24	44.40	33.88
09-Jul-24	50.70	39.00
23-Apr-24	56.70	41.97
04-Feb-24	57.80	39.90
21-Jan-24	58.10	39.35
19-Oct-23	67.30	53.80

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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